

Project Requirements Summary

Rafael Labra & Juan José Buenahora

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Problem. Latin American individuals with mid-to-high incomes increasingly manage finances across multiple bank accounts, fintech platforms, cards, shared household expenses, subscriptions, and currencies. No single tool currently gives them a unified, automated, real-time picture of their financial life. On the institutional side, Latin American fintechs and financial institutions have limited access to structured, high-quality individual financial behavior data, which constrains their ability to assess creditworthiness and design personalized financial products.

Target user. Latin American banked or semi-banked individuals with any level of financial knowledge who want to track, understand, and optimize their personal finances. The product must be accessible enough for someone who has never used a budgeting tool, yet powerful enough for someone managing a household with a partner, multiple accounts, and foreign currency income.

Target customer. Latin American fintechs and financial institutions seeking behavioral and creditworthiness signals on individuals. Over time, this expands to consumer goods, travel, and leisure companies that benefit from understanding individual financial patterns.

Core product requirements. The platform must automatically capture transactions from bank email notifications (Gmail and Outlook), direct bank connections (Luka Connect for Chile and the broader LATAM region), and open banking APIs (Plaid for the United States). Every transaction must be AI-classified and delivered to the user in real time via WhatsApp, with no manual entry required as the default. Users must be able to manage shared household expenses, track subscriptions, set and monitor budgets, and visualize their spending across multiple currencies, all from a single web dashboard. The experience must work equally well on mobile and desktop.

Geographic and currency requirements. The product is LATAM-first. All transaction capture, parsing, classification, and display logic must support multiple countries and currencies without hardcoding assumptions about any single market. The current scope covers Chile, Colombia, Mexico, Peru, Brazil, and the United States, across 101 banks. New countries and banks must be addable without architectural changes.

Technical requirements. The backend is built on Python and FastAPI with an asynchronous PostgreSQL layer and a two-tier job queue separating real-time email processing from heavier bank sync and LLM workloads. The frontend is a Next.js application with mobile-first responsive design. Transaction parsing uses a three-layer approach — declarative templates at zero LLM cost, a Gemini model waterfall for unknown formats, and a regex fallback for legacy bank patterns — with an autonomous agent that promotes new templates to production as data accumulates. All amounts follow a unified sign convention across all data sources. Security requirements include encrypted credential storage, JWT-based authentication with local validation, and row-level security on sensitive tables.

Product and development principles. Every decision must center on the user experience. Simplicity and clarity take priority over feature richness. The development team consists of two Wharton MBAs with engineering backgrounds; the working model favors short, readable code, asking clarifying questions before building, and using state-of-the-art tools rather than defaulting to the familiar. New features require a brainstorming alignment step before implementation, a code review after significant changes, and a verification pass before any feature is marked complete.

Business model. Luka operates a two-sided revenue model. Users pay a small subscription that keeps their individual data private. B2B customers — fintechs and financial institutions — pay for access to aggregated, anonymized behavioral data. The user always takes priority: a large, satisfied user base generating behavioral data is the foundation that makes the institutional product valuable. The model is expected to evolve as the product scales, and opportunities to expand or refine it should be flagged as they arise during development.